# Andrew W. Shenstone

Shenstone, Andrew - Application for Senior Software Engineer - Fusion @ Builder.io

339-223-0797 • shenst1@gmail.com • linkedin.com/in/ashenstone • github.com/shenst1

## ABOUT ME

I am a senior software engineer with 12+ years of experience building full-stack applications. I have a proven track record of architecting and shipping complex, user-focused products from concept to scale. I excel at balancing technical excellence with product impact, and I'm passionate about bridging the gap between technical complexity and user-friendly experiences.

## BUILDER.IO APPLICATION

As an early adopter of headless CMS platforms, I've spent years understanding the unique challenges of making developer-centric tools accessible to non-technical users. At Ply Interactive, I built our in-house CMS from the ground up, and I've extensively used DatoCMS across multiple projects. My experience building Plantfolio, implementing AI-powered features, and owning the full product cycle from customer discovery to production directly aligns with Builder.io's need for engineers who can partner with Product and Design. As a top 1% user of Cursor IDE, I'm an expert with AI-assisted development tools and understand how AI can bridge the gap between intent and execution.

## SKILLS

**Frontend:** TypeScript, React 19, Next.js 15, Tailwind CSS, Shadcn UI, React Hook Form, Zustand, Framer Motion

**Backend:** Node.js, PostgreSQL, Prisma, Server Actions, API Design

**CMS & Content:** DatoCMS, Headless CMS Architecture, Custom CMS Development, Content Modeling

**AI/ML:** OpenAI API, AI SDK, Vector Embeddings, Natural Language Processing, Retrieval Augmented Generation (RAG)

**Architecture:** Monorepos, Microservices, Event-driven Systems, Performance Optimization

**Cloud & Tools:** AWS (S3, EC2), Vercel, Algolia, Inngest, Clerk Auth, Stripe, Git, CI/CD, pnpm, Turbo, Cursor IDE (Top 1% user)

## EXPERIENCE

---

### Founder & Lead Engineer

**Plantfolio** | November 2023 - Present

#### Product Leadership & Architecture

- Architected and built a comprehensive plant management platform from the ground up, serving as both technical lead and product owner
- Owned the full feature cycle: joined customer calls to identify friction points, architected solutions, implemented, tested, and verified success in production
- Designed and implemented a sophisticated monorepo architecture with 12+ packages, enabling rapid development and maintainable codebases
- Led product strategy and user experience decisions, making product micro-decisions and navigating ambiguity to deliver value iteratively

#### Technical Achievements

- AI Integration: Built advanced AI-powered features including plant identification from photos, contextual chatbot (Sage), and smart text extraction from plant tags using OpenAI's vision and language models
- Modern Frontend Architecture: Implemented Next.js 15 with React 19, React Server Components, and TypeScript, achieving exceptional performance and developer experience

- Complex Data Modeling: Designed and implemented sophisticated PostgreSQL schemas with Prisma, handling complex relationships between users, plants, folios, and media with 15+ interconnected models
- Content Management: Created sophisticated content management system with rich text editing, plant tagging, and flexible data structures

### Scale & Performance

- Managed a database of 40,000+ plant species with advanced search capabilities using Algolia and vector embeddings
- Implemented comprehensive media management system with AWS S3, supporting image optimization, galleries, and metadata extraction
- Built robust authentication and authorization systems with Clerk, supporting multiple user types and subscription tiers
- Optimized application performance through React Server Components, efficient data fetching, and strategic caching

### Client Case Study - AI Signage

- Delivered a production rollout for an independent garden center to automate plant signage generation
- Enabled bulk plant import (plain text) to printable signs in seconds; reduced a weekend-long manual process to minutes after initial setup
- Demonstrated ability to translate customer requirements into scalable technical solutions and shorten feedback loops

### Full-Stack Ownership

- Developed complete payment integration with Stripe, subscription management, and user onboarding flows
- Built comprehensive email system with React Email, supporting transactional emails, notifications, and marketing campaigns
- Implemented advanced search and filtering capabilities with Algolia, supporting complex plant queries and user preferences

### Code Quality & Leadership

- Established coding standards and architectural patterns that enabled rapid, consistent development
- Implemented comprehensive testing strategy with Vitest and Cypress, maintaining high code quality
- Built reusable component library and design system, ensuring consistent UI/UX across the platform

---

## Senior Software Engineer

**Tilia** | January 2023 - August 2023

- Partnered with cross-functional teams in product and design to revamp critical user-facing features
- Spearheaded and guided a team through the successful adoption of Chakra UI, reducing bespoke components and establishing cohesive design patterns
- Maintained exceptional unit test coverage of over 90% for the Tools team application, alongside comprehensive end-to-end testing
- Led the swift creation and deployment of a homepage reporting dashboard within the initial two months of joining

---

## Senior Software Engineer

**Bloom.wine** | September 2020 - October 2022

- Architected a greenfield Next.js application for the primary admin interface of the Bloom product
- Engineered Ruby on Rails GraphQL API endpoints shared by multiple applications across mobile and web devices
- Collaborated with designers using Figma, establishing component library standards usable by both engineering and design

- Integrated DatoCMS and extended application functionality through third-party API integrations (Shopify, Mailchimp, Stripe, Shipstation, ActiveCampaign)

---

## Software Engineer II

**Tune Inc - Marketplace Automation** | August 2019 - May 2020

- Automated a client workflow using a Node.js/Express API and React.js, reducing the time to complete the task from 10-15 minutes to 10-30 seconds
- Modernized the primary legacy React.js application by moving from a custom Webpack process to react-scripts, resulting in a 50% reduction in production build size and a 60% reduction in NPM dependencies
- Reduced development machine CPU usage from 75% to <5% by simplifying the build pipeline and dependency graph

---

## Software Developer

**Ply Interactive Inc** | June 2014 - July 2019

- Developed numerous web applications including The Washington State Fair, Georgetownbeer.com, WashingtonWine.org, TwoWolvesWine.com, Novaerus.com, WellAir, and Plasma-air.com
- Built a standalone Ruby gem Content Management System, enabling simplified content management within Ruby on Rails projects
- Transitioned the agency to modern technologies like GraphQL, Gatsby.js, and React.js, improving delivery times for new projects
- Bloom.wine Product Development: Built extensive reporting features using complex PostgreSQL queries and interactive filtering, saving clients thousands of hours on previously manual tasks
- Engineered a flexible Wine Club membership structure for wineries, allowing for diverse client configuration and broadening the range of potential sales targets

- Communicated and enforced the standards of Shopify's Polaris React.js component library with designers, resulting in efficiencies gained from leveraging pre-built components

## COMPANY REFERENCE

**Plantfolio** (2023-Present) - AI-powered plant management platform with 40,000+ plant database serving both consumer garden management and independent garden center services - plantfolio.garden/

**Tilia** (2023) - All-in-one payment platform for digital economies - tilia.io/

**Bloom.wine** (2020-2022) - Leader in commerce services for the alcohol industry - bloom.wine/

**Tune Inc - Marketplace Automation** (2019-2020) - SaaS platform for managing marketing partnerships across mobile and web - tune.com/

**Ply Interactive Inc** (2014-2019) - Boutique agency specializing in pixel-perfect custom websites and mobile applications; developed Bloom.wine product internally (2017-2019)